

Search option MVP

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This is pertaining to search option in Mapit MVP design.

The current setting includes registered user to first set the location. Users are given option to set multiple locations also. However, if a user (as a buyer) wants to search listings in some other area, the search function does not support this.

Currently, when user pans and zooms to other location and type keywords in the search bar, the search is only limited to the 'current pin location' and the proximity distance selected by the user. We want to provide user an option to search in other locations, without having to save GPS pin for every search.

My thought is to create a toggle button, which either carries out the search based on the pin location selected by the user OR considering current center position of the map and proximity preference, when hitting the search button. In addition, it would be good to provide a 'blue pin' as a visual representation when the user toggles to 'free search'.

Please let me know your thoughts.

James response

This is a solid UX idea and well thought through. Here's my take:

Your toggle approach is the right instinct. The two modes map cleanly to two distinct user intents — "search near my saved places" vs. "search anywhere I'm looking" — and making that explicit is better than trying to infer intent.

A few thoughts on refinement:

On the toggle itself

A toggle works, but consider labeling it around intent rather than mechanism. Something like **"My Locations" / "Explore Area"** is more intuitive than "Pin Search / Map Center Search." The label should tell the user what they're doing, not how it works internally.

On the blue pin

Good idea — visual feedback is essential here. A few suggestions to make it work better:

- The blue pin should appear at the exact center of the map viewport and move as the user pans. This gives real-time feedback that the search origin is following their view.
- Show a faint proximity radius circle around it (same as you likely do for saved pins), so the user can see the search footprint before they search.
- When they lift their finger / stop panning, you could auto-trigger a search (like Google Maps does) rather than requiring a tap on the search button — but this is optional and depends on your backend query cost.

One UX concern to consider

If the user is in "Explore Area" mode and types a keyword in the search bar, it's now ambiguous: are they searching by keyword within the current map view, or do they also want the map to jump to a location by name? You may want to handle text input slightly differently in each mode — e.g.,

in Explore mode, a typed location name could *move the map* rather than filter listings.

Alternative worth considering

Instead of a persistent toggle, some apps use a **“Search this area” button** that appears only after the user pans/zooms — similar to how Airbnb and Google Maps handle it. This is lower friction (no mode switching) and may feel more natural. The downside is discoverability — users may not know to pan first.

My recommendation

Go with your toggle for MVP — it’s explicit and easier to build. Place it prominently near the search bar (not buried in settings), default it to “My Locations” so existing behavior is unchanged, and use the blue pin + radius circle for visual grounding. You can always evolve toward a “search this area” button pattern post-launch based on user behavior.

Want me to sketch out the UI flow or think through the frontend implementation for this?